

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

STLC Cheat Sheet

The Software Testing Life Cycle at a glance.

Introduction

The STLC is the testing-specific process that runs alongside the SDLC, from analysing requirements to closing out testing.

The Phases

Phase	Purpose	Key deliverable
Requirement analysis	Understand what to test	Testability notes, questions
Test planning	Scope, approach, schedule	Test plan
Test design	Write cases and prepare data	Test cases, test data
Environment setup	Prepare a system to test	Ready test environment
Test execution	Run tests, log defects	Results, defect reports
Test closure	Report and learn	Test summary report

Entry & Exit Criteria

- Entry criteria: what must be ready before a phase starts.
- Exit criteria: what must be true before a phase is considered done.

Common Mistakes

- Jumping to execution with no planning or design.
- No clear exit criteria, so testing stops when time runs out.
- Designing test cases with no test data prepared.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Agree entry/exit criteria in writing, early — they are your best protection against being blamed for a rushed release.